

A Complete Guide to Windows 10 Registry Tweaks

By

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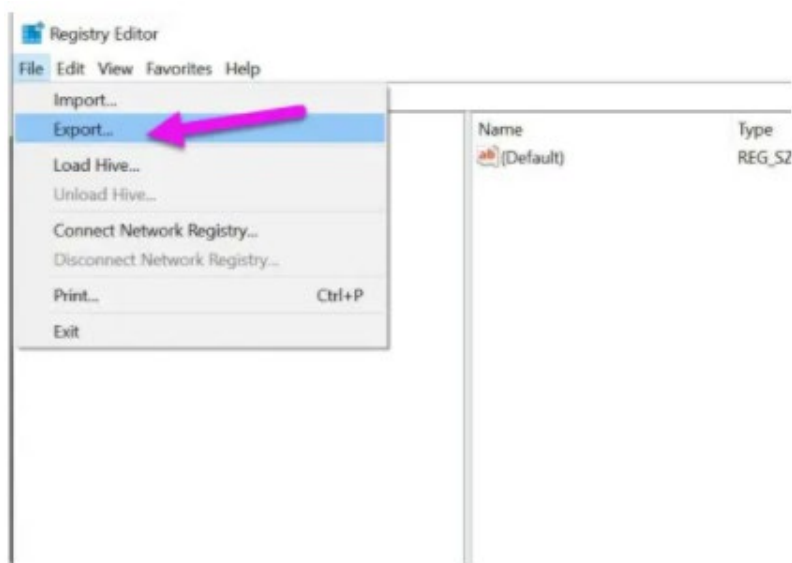
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Are you looking for **windows 10 registry tweaks** in one place, this post is completely for you. The Windows Registry is where the operating system stores all the settings that are required for Windows and installed software to function properly. Every time you install a program, data about it gets written to this database.

Because the Registry is such an integral part of the whole Windows set-up, it's important to take care when making any changes to it. Any slip-up could potentially cause major problems with the operating system.

For this reason, you should always **back up the Registry before making any changes to it**, just to be on the safe side.

To Open Windows Registry, Open the [Run menu](#) and enter the command "**regedit**" without quotes. You can easily backup your Registry settings by **File > Export**.



Many PC users deliberately **avoid fiddling with the Registry**, preferring to leave system tweaks to software such as [CCleaner](#).

But provided you're careful and know how to undo any changes you make, there are plenty of benefits to delving under the bonnet of your computer, such as customizing Windows to make it look and behave the way you want, speeding up your PC and turning off features you don't need.

Messing with the Registry can be risky, but it can also, yield impressive results.

A Complete Guide to Windows 10 Registry Tweaks

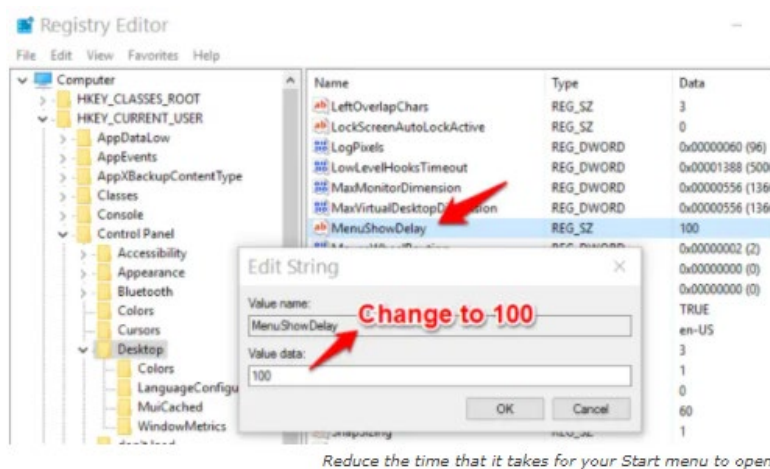
1. SPEED UP WINDOWS 10

1.1 Speed up your Start menu

When you open the Start menu or select a program in Windows, there's a noticeable pause. This is true regardless of whether you're using Windows 7 or Windows 10. You can remove these delays and make the menu feel faster by navigating to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop

Locate the entry '**MenuShowDelay**' on the right. This is the speed at which the menu opens. Right-click it, select Modify and reduce the value data from **400** to around **100**.



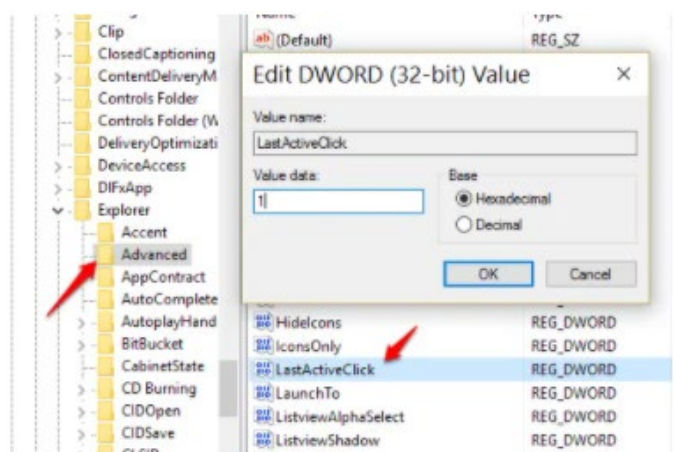
1.2 Instantly switch to the last active window

When you hover over a taskbar button in Windows 7, 8 or 10, you'll see thumbnails for all the open windows relating to it. You can then select the one you require, but if you'd rather save time by just opening the last active window instead, a simple Registry tweak will change the default behavior of the taskbar buttons.

Go to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced

Create a new DWORD (32-bit) on the right-hand side, and name it '**LastActiveClick**'. Set the value to 1



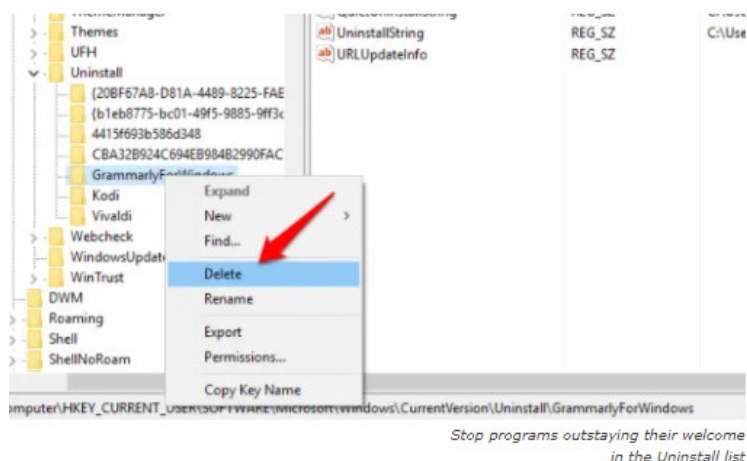
Save time by always switching to the last active window

1.3 Remove problem entries from the Windows uninstaller

If you've had a problem uninstalling a program – for example if the uninstall has gone wrong or you've simply deleted it – you may still see it listed in the 'Uninstall or change a program' list in the Control Panel.

One solution is to try reinstalling and then uninstalling the software, but if that doesn't work, navigate to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall



Find the program entry you want to remove and delete it. **This won't uninstall the program, but it will remove the offending entry.** It works in Windows 7 and upwards.

1.4 Speed up your shutdown

Windows waits for running applications and processes to end before it shuts down, but these sometimes hang and take ages to close. You can reduce the amount of time Windows waits by tweaking the Registry. Go to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop

double-click **HungAppTimeout** and change the default value from **5000** to **1000**.

Do the same for the entry **WaitToKillAppTimeout**. Navigate to: **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control**

and double-click the entry **WaitToKillServiceTimeout**, then change the value data to **1000**.

You can also force Windows to automatically close any non-responding programs by going to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop

Double-click **AutoEndTasks** and change the value from 0 to 1.

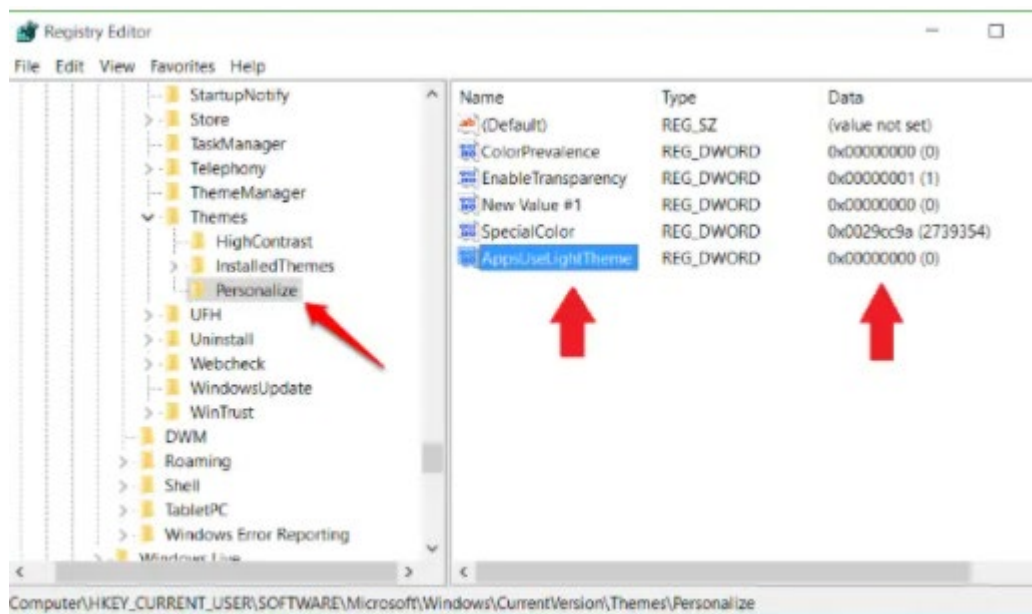
2. CHANGE HOW WINDOWS 10 LOOKS

2.1 Enable Windows 10's hidden 'dark' theme

By default, Microsoft's new operating system uses a light theme, but you can unlock a dark alternative by using a simple Registry tweak. Navigate to

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\ Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\ Themes\Personalize

then right-click in the right-hand pane and select New, DWORD (32-bit). Name it '**AppsUseLightTheme**'. Right-click it and select Modify. Make sure the Value Data is set to 0.



Restart your PC, or log off and log on again, and the dark theme will be applied. Change the value to 1, or delete the DWORD to go back to the default light theme.

2.2 Change the Windows 10 logon screen to a solid color

If you'd prefer to have the Windows 10 logon screen display a color rather than an image, which may make it load slightly faster, navigate to

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\ Policies\Microsoft\Windows\System

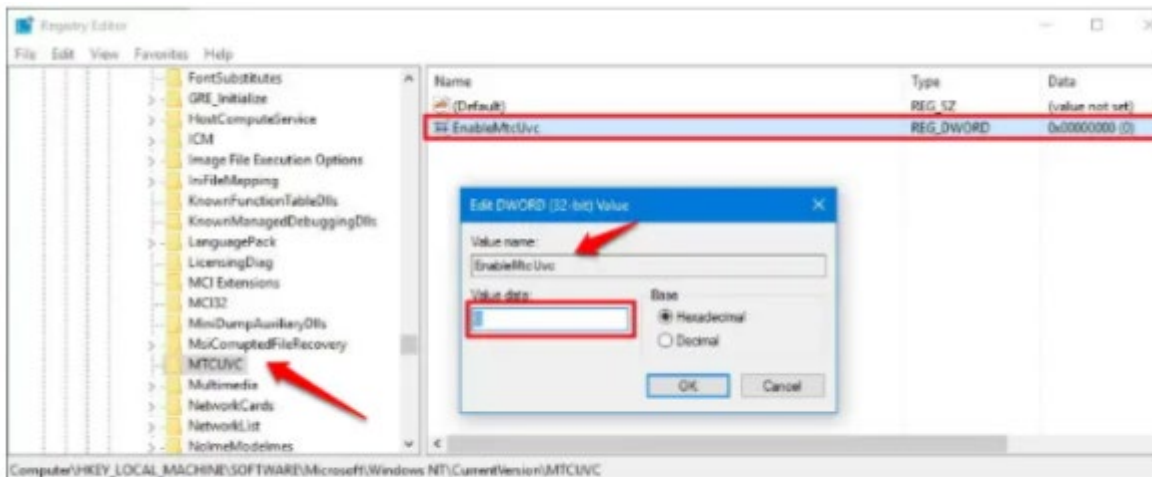
and right-click in the right-hand pane. Select New, DWORD (32-bit) and name it '**DisableLogonBackgroundImage**', then give it a value of **1**. Windows 10 will use the same color as your Desktop wallpaper. You can change this under Settings, Personalisation, Colours.

2.3 Get back the old volume control in Windows 10

Windows 10 introduces a new, horizontal volume control. If you prefer the old up-and-down vertical style, get it back by going to

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\ CurrentVersion

Right-click CurrentVersion and select New Key. Name it '**MTCUVC**' and, in the right-hand pane, right-click and create a new DWORD (32-bit).



You can make the Windows 10 volume slider vertical again

2.4 Restore the old clock and calendar in Windows 10

Clicking the time in your System Tray in Windows 10 opens a transparent clock and calendar panel. We quite like it, but the 'modern' look won't be to everyone's taste. If you preferred the old design, you can get it back by navigating to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\ImmersiveShell

Right-click in the pane on the right and select New, DWORD (32-bit). Name it '**UseWin32TrayClockExperience**'.

Right-click the entry, select Modify and set the value to **1**. Now, when you click the time, it will open a panel with the classic clock and calendar interface.

2.5 Change icon spacing on the Desktop

If you're running Windows 8 or 10, you can adjust the horizontal and vertical spacing around icons on the Desktop by tweaking the Registry (Windows 7 offers controls to do this). Navigate to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop\WindowMetrics

and look for the '**IconSpacing**' and '**IconVerticalSpacing**' keys. Increase the number for each to pad out the spacing between icons. The values are in twips (twentieth of a point). Roughly, -17 is equal to 1 pixel and -28 equals 2 pixels.

2.6 Customise window borders and scrollbars

In Windows 7, you can make the size of window borders and scrollbars super-thin. Go to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop\WindowMetrics

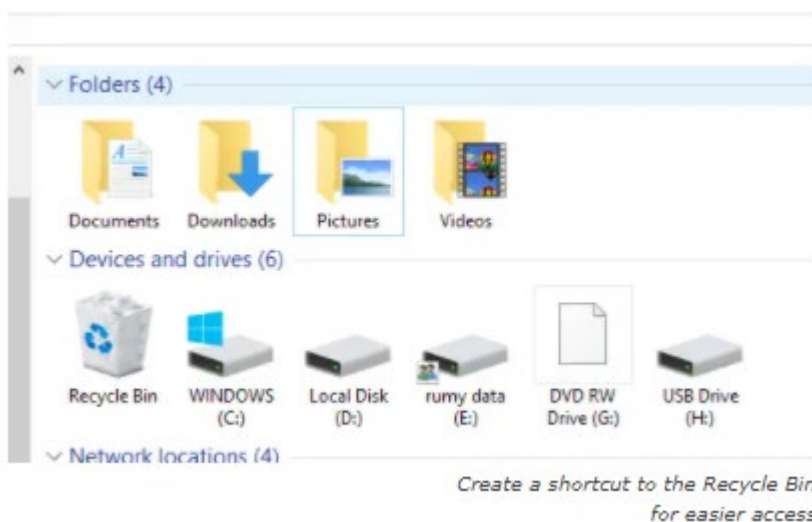
and set '**PaddedBorderWidth**' to -0, and both '**ScrollWidth**' and '**ScrollHeight**' to -200. As with icon spacing, these values are in twips. If you want super-fat borders, change the figure to -750, or anything less than that figure.

2.7 Add the Recycle Bin to Computer or This PC

To save you returning to the Desktop to check the [Recycle Bin](#) for your deleted files, you can add a shortcut to Computer (or This PC in Windows 10) by navigating to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\ SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\ MyComputer\NameSpace

Right-click in the pane on the right and select New, Key. Name it **{645FF040-5081-101B-9F08-00AA002F954E}**.



Now, when you go into Computer, you should see the Recycle Bin. This works in all versions of Microsoft's OS, from Windows 7 to 10.

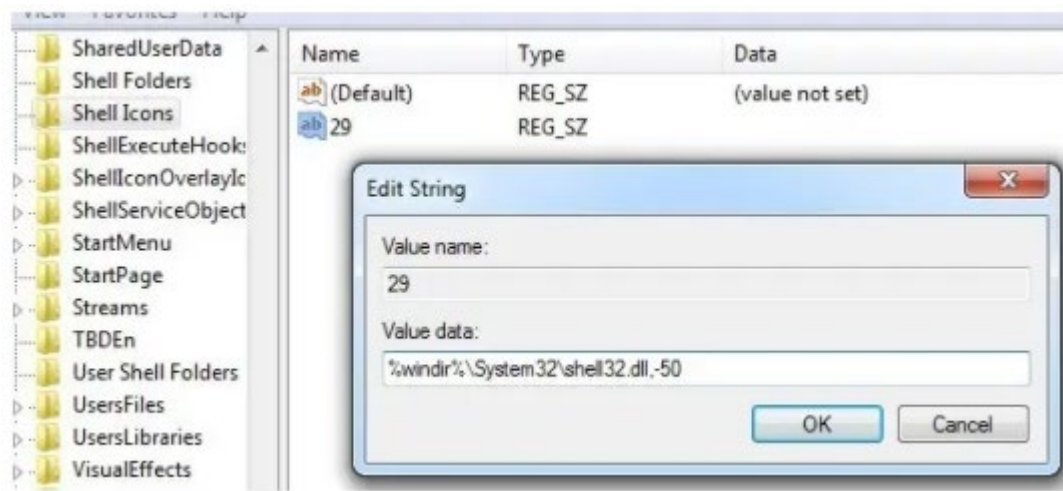
2.8 Remove the arrows from shortcuts

When you create a shortcut (or a program creates one for you), the icon appears with a small arrow in the bottom-left corner. Removing this will make shortcut icons look tidier.

To do this, navigate to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\ SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Shell Icons

(if you don't see Shell Icons, you'll need to create this key). Right-click the right-hand pane to create a new String Value. Name it '**29**'. Double-click it and change the Value Data to '**C:\Windows\System32\shell32.dll,50**'.



Close the Registry editor, click Start and type CMD. Hit enter.

In the Command Prompt window, type:

taskkill /IM explorer.exe /F

and hit Enter. This will close Windows Explorer, so don't be alarmed when the taskbar vanishes. Next, type the following three commands, hitting Enter after each one:

cd /d %userprofile%\AppData\Local
del IconCache.db /a
shutdown /r

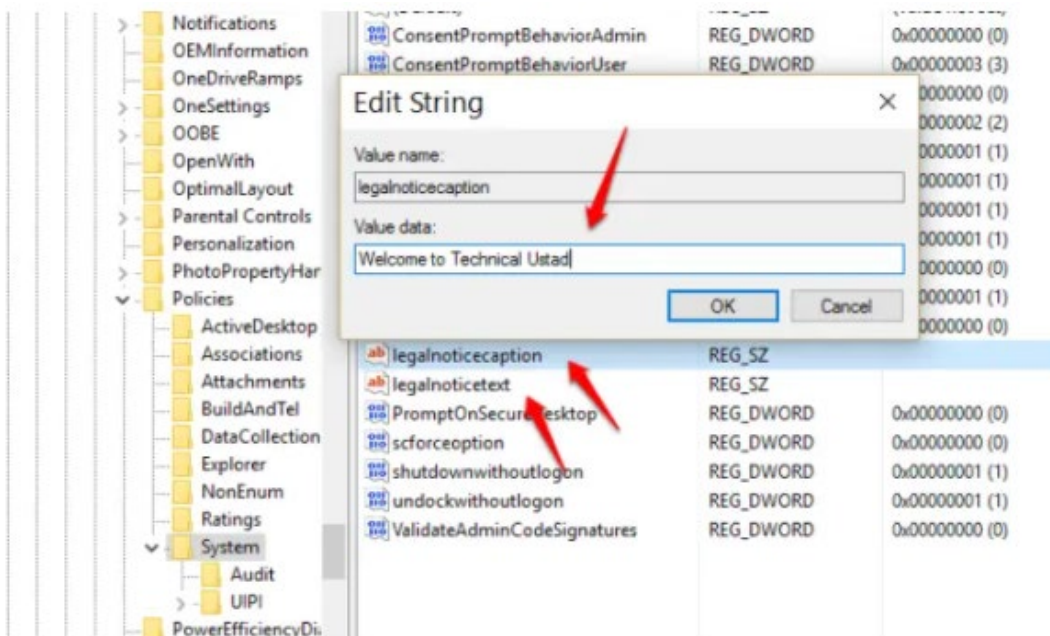
This final command will restart your PC. When it reboots, the shortcut arrows will be gone. To restore them, simply delete the 29-string value. This trick works in all recent versions of Windows.

2.9 Add a custom message to your login screen

You can add a message of your choice to the Windows 10 login screen that will be the first thing you see when it boots up. To do this, navigate to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\ Current Version\Policies\System

Double-click '**legalnoticecaption**' and enter a title for your message in the Value Data box. Click OK. Double-click '**legalnoticetext**' and enter your message.



Log out, and the message will appear when you log back in. To clear it each time, click OK.

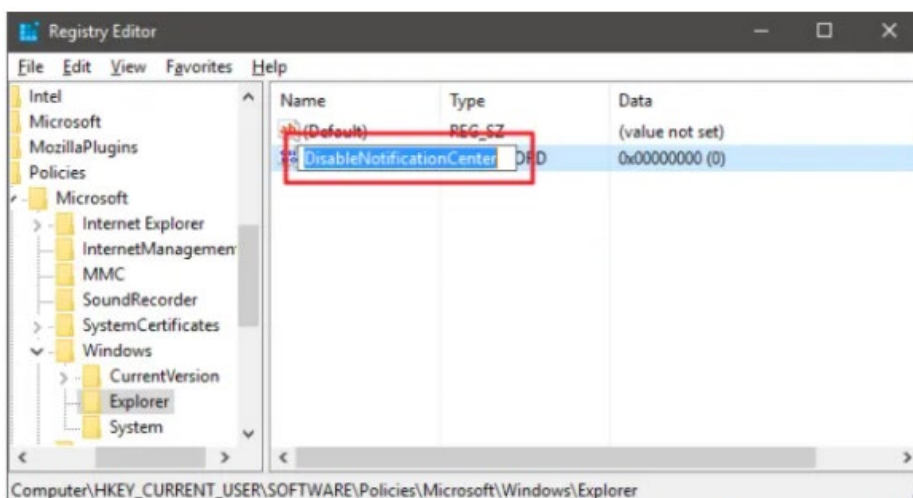
3. IMPROVE HOW WINDOWS 10 WORKS

3.1 Remove the Action Center from Windows 10

The Action Center is a new feature in Windows 10 that displays notifications from apps and your system. If you don't need it (and most people don't), you can remove it by going to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\Explorer.

Right-click in the right-hand pane and select New, DWORD (32-bit) Call it '**DisableNotificationCenter**'. Double-click it and change the Value Data to **1**.



Remove the Action Center to hide Windows 10 notifications

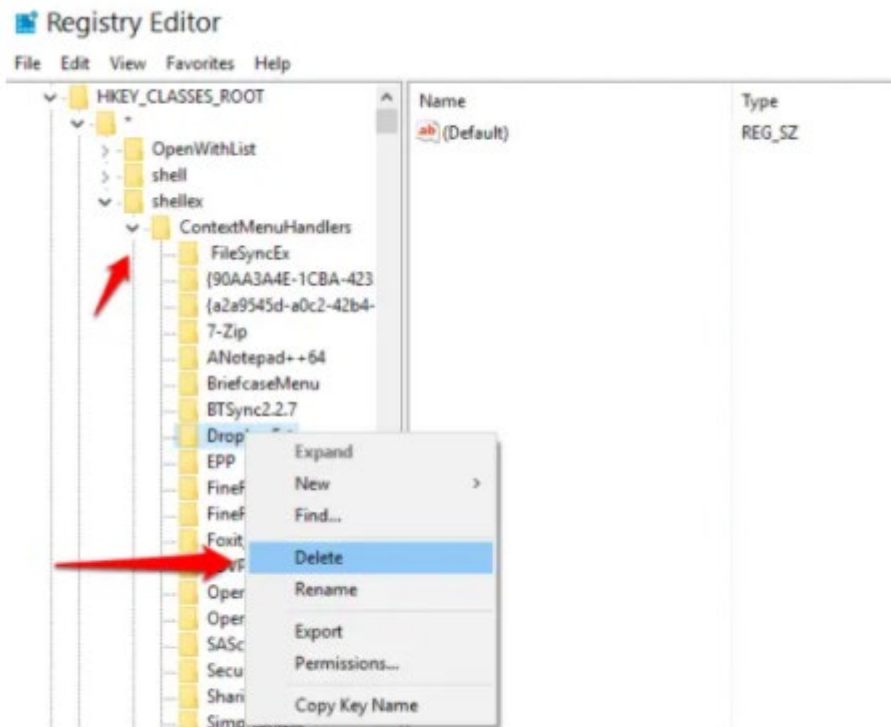
Click OK and exit the Registry Editor. The Action Center will vanish from the taskbar when you next restart your PC.

3.2 Remove unwanted entries from the right-click menu

The right-click 'context' menu gives you instant access to various options that change depending on where you are in Windows and what software you have installed. The menu can become cluttered over time and fill up with entries you don't use.

To manage the **context menu entries** using the Registry, navigate to

HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT*\shell\ ContextMenuHandlers



Clean up your right-click menu by removing unwanted entries

A list of programs that have added themselves to the context menu will be displayed. To remove an entry, just select and delete it, but make sure you know what it is before you get rid of it. This works in all versions of Windows.

3.3 Disable Security Center notifications

Windows runs regular checks to make sure important security functions – such as your antivirus, firewall and Windows Updates – are running, and alerts you if there's a problem. If you've deliberately turned off these security features, being alerted to the change can soon become annoying.

To disable these alerts, go to:

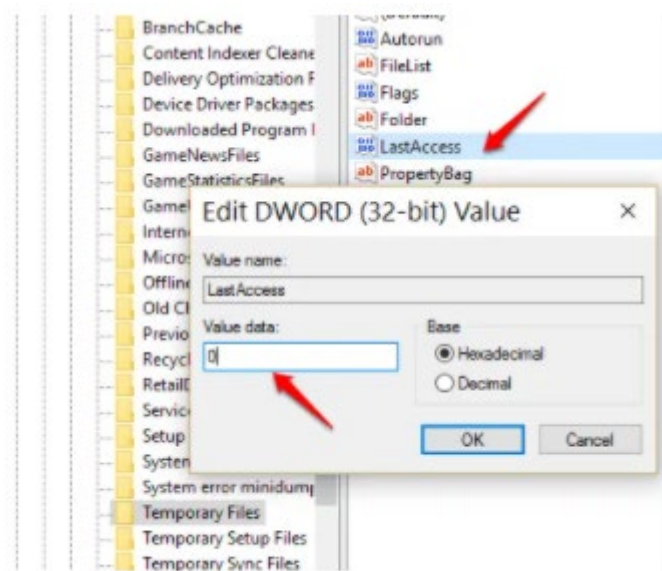
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\ SOFTWARE \Microsoft\Security Center\Svc

In '**AntiVirusDisableNotify**', '**FirewallDisableNotify**' and/or '**UpdatesDisableNotify**', change the values from 0 to 1. This works in Windows 7 and 8.1, but not in 10.

3.4 Force Disk Cleanup to delete newer files

If you use the built-in Windows Disk Cleanup tool to remove junk files from your PC, you may have noticed that it leaves newer files behind. You can force it to clean up these more recent junk files in any version of Windows by navigating to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\VolumeCaches\Temporary Files



Make sure Disk Cleanup deletes the latest junk files from your PC

Double-click '**LastAccess**' and change its value from **7** (days) to **0** to delete all newer files.

3.5 Stop Windows Update restarting your PC

Being forced to restart your PC to install updates when you're in the middle of something can be annoying and time-consuming, but Windows Update is very persistent. You can stop it from bothering you in Windows 7 and Vista (later versions don't have this problem) by tweaking the Registry. Go to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\WindowsUpdate\AU

then right-click in the right-hand pane and choose New, DWORD (32-bit) Value. Name the value '**NoAutoRebootWithLoggedOnUsers**', then double-click it, enter a value data of 1 and click OK.

If the WindowsUpdate\AU entry doesn't exist, right-click Windows, choose New, Key and name the key WindowsUpdate. Now right-click this key, choose New, Key and name it AU.

3.6 Disable or delay taskbar previews

When you hover your mouse over an open program or folder in the taskbar, Windows displays a thumbnail preview. This happens in Windows 7, 8+ and 10. If you find this feature annoying rather than helpful, you can disable it by navigating to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced

Locate '**ExtendedUIHoverTime**' on the right (create it if it isn't there) and double-click it. Change the value to something like 10000. This is the time, in milliseconds, before the preview appears, so a large number will stop it popping up.

3.7 Remove OneDrive from File Explorer in Windows 10

Microsoft's cloud storage service is built into Windows 10. If you don't use it, you can prevent it from being included in File Explorer (this tweak won't actually uninstall the service). Navigate to:

HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID{018D5C66-4533-4307-9B53- 224DE2ED1FE6}

then double-click the value name '**System.IsPinnedToNameSpaceTree**' and change the value to 0. Restart your PC to make the change.

3.8 Remove the Quick Access entry from File Explorer

If you'd prefer not to have your most recently opened files and folders appear in File Explorer, you can remove Quick Access and keep that information private.

First, hide the feature by going to View, Options. Under the **General tab**, change '**Open File Explorer**' to 'from '**Quick access**' to '**This PC**'.

Next, open Regedit and navigate to:

HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID{679f85cb-0220-4080-b29b5540cc05aab6}

Expand it and right-click '**ShellFolder**'. Select **Permissions**, then click the Advanced button.

In the '**Advanced Security Settings for ShellFolder**' box, click the 'Change' link, then click 'Advanced', click the 'Find Now' button and, in the 'Search results' box, select 'Administrators'. Click OK twice, then Apply, and hit OK until the box closes.

In 'ShellFolder', double-click 'Attributes', and change data value to 'a0600000', then click OK. Restart your PC.

3.9 Remove low drive-space alerts

Windows will notify you when you're running out of space on your hard drive, which is helpful, but can become irritating – it's more common on [laptops than desktop](#) PCs. You can disable this prompt in Windows 7 onwards by navigating to:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies

Right-click 'Policies' and select New, Key. Call this new key 'Explorer', then right-click it and select New, DWORD (32-bit). Call the value '**NoLowDiskSpaceChecks**'. Double-click it and changes the value to 1.

3.10 Disable the Caps Lock key in Windows 10

It's very easy to knock the Caps Lock key accidentally so that you end up TYPING WHOLE SENTENCES IN CAPITALS. It's not vital to have Caps Lock enabled because you can just hold down Shift when you need to type upper-case letters.

To disable the Caps Lock key, navigate to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Keyboard Layout

Right-click anywhere in the right-hand pane and choose New, Binary Value. Name the value 'Scancode Map' and double-click it. Now comes the tricky part. On the first line, enter the value data: 0000 00 00 00 00 00 00 00 00 (the first four zeros will be filled in automatically, then it's another eight pairs). On the second line 0008 will be filled in automatically for you; after this, type 02 00 00 00 00 00 3A 00.

Finally, after the 0010 on the third line, type 00 00 00 00. Click OK to save the data, restart your PC and Caps Lock will be disabled. To turn it back on again, just delete the Scancode Map value and restart your PC.

Switch off annoying ads

Since Windows 10, Microsoft is continuously testing out how it can annoy users with self-advertising in Explorer and in the Start menu. Luckily, these ads can be disabled in two ways.

In Explorer, go to "View | Options | Change Folder and Search Options". In the "View" disable the "Notifications of the Synchronisation host" option.

In the registry, you can find the DWORD value "ShowSyncProviderNotification" using the path HKEY_CURRENT_USER | Software | Microsoft | Windows | CurrentVersion | Explorer | Advanced". Set it to "0"

Disabling Microsoft shenanigans

Since Windows 10, a folder for "3D objects" is located in the standard list. It is expected to be saved with the other files of the Microsoft App 3D Builder, which only a few users use.

In order to hide this folder, go to "HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE | SOFTWARE | Microsoft | Windows | CurrentVersion | Explorer | MyComputer | Namespace" in regedit and delete the "0DB7E03F-FC29-4DC6-9020-FF41B59E513A" folder.

Carry out the same operation for 64-Bit in the "Namespace" folder of the "Wow6432Node" branch as well. For those who do not use Microsoft's cloud service, the bothersome OneDrive entry between "Quick Access" and the PC drives can also be hidden using regedit.

Navigate to the "HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID" folder and look for the "018D5C66" string. Open the corresponding folder and change the "System. IsPinnedToNameSpaceTree" value from "1" to "0" by double-clicking.

Hide drives

With a small registry entry, one can make entire drives disappear since Windows will no longer show it. That can happen also in the registry using the "HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE | Software | Microsoft | Windows | Current Version | Policies | Explorer" path.

Here, click on the right window and create the entry "NoDrives" using the context menu "New | DWORD value (32 bit)". Open it by double-clicking and change its "Basis" to "Decimal". The "Value" that you enter depends on the drive letter that you want to hide.

The partition "D:", for example, has the value "8". It continues further, "E:" has "10", "F:" has "20", "G:" "40" and "H:" can be hidden using "80". After a renewed login, the drive designated by you will disappear.

Immobilise Cortana

Cortana is and remains the most controversial because the assistant sends regularly sends language data to Microsoft for analysis. Since the Creators Update, Cortana can be disabled only from the registry.

First, go to "HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE | SOFTWARE | Policies | Microsoft | Windows" in regedit and create (if not already available) the folder "Windows Search" in the right window using the context menu "New | Key". Here, you can generate an entry using "New | DWORD value (32-Bit) | AllowCortana" and assign the value "0" to it. Implement the operation as usual on a 64-bit Windows under "WOW6432Node".

Hide Action Center

One can manage very well without the new Action Center, which lurks in the right edge of the screen and occasionally throws a pop-up window your way. The displayed messages are often insignificant, for example, the daily notification that the [virus scanner](#) has not found any threat.

To disable the Center, go to "HKEY_CURRENT_USER | SOFTWARE | Policies | Microsoft | Windows" in the registry. If it is not available yet, create a folder here with the name "New | Key | Explorer" and in that "New | DWORD value (32-Bit) | DisableNotificationCentre". Open it with a double-click and assign the value "1" to it.

Automatically Delete Pagefile.sys at Shutdown

[Pagefile.sys](#) acts as a virtual RAM which Windows uses as RAM to store programs that are not in use, thus putting less pressure on the actual RAM. Although it is not recommended to disable it, you can delete it to save space and also avoid any vulnerabilities.

The page file size is mostly near the size of your actual RAM, so it can take up a lot of space depending on your RAM. When it is set to delete with a shutdown, you will save space but at the expense of prolonging shutdown time. In the registry editor go to:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE \ SYSTEM \ CurrentControlSet \ ControlSession \ ManagerMemory Management

Click on "Memory Management," and then double-click on "ClearPageFileAtShutdown" in the panel on the right. Set its value to "1," and restart

the PC. Every time you shut down your PC, the pagefile will be deleted. Don't worry – it will be created again when needed.

Adjust the distance of the desktop icons, mimicking the previous Windows 7 look

In Windows 10, the space between the desktop icons is considerably larger as compared to the earlier versions.

But that can be reversed. Open the "Run" window using the shortcut [Windows] + [R], enter "regedit" and press "OK".

In the registry, navigate to the path

"HKEY_CURRENT_USER\ControlPanel\Desktop\WindowMetrics"

You will see a value "-1710" next to the **"Icon-VerticalSpacing"** file in the window to the right. After double-clicking on the file name, you can change the value to "-1125" in the **"Edit string"** window just like in Windows 7 and in 8.

In order to adjust the horizontal value, open the **"Icon spacing"** file, enter "-1125" and click on "OK". Then close the registry and restart your computer. When you load back in, your desktop will have a different feel to it.

Registry tools

For those who often edit the registry, the Spartan regedit is not sufficient. Other tools offer significantly more functions:

[RegCool](#) is a powerful registry editor with many additional functions, which allows you to also edit registry entries that are protected by the system.

[RegScanner](#) has a comfortable search function to display only the recently changed entries, for instance.

[Registry Finder](#) has a multiple window view to compare entries with each other in a better manner.

Display seconds in the system tray clock

The clock at the bottom-right lets you see the current hours and minutes, but if you want to know exactly how long is left to go in the current minute, you can add the seconds to the clock by going to

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced

Right-click in the right-hand pane and select **New, DWORD (32-bit) Value**. Call this **ShowSecondsInSystemClock**. Doubleclick the new entry and change its value to 1, then click OK and restart your PC.

Add the Windows version to your desktop

If you run an Insider version of Windows 10, you'll see a watermark on the bottom the right-hand side of the desktop showing the version of Windows you're running and the build number. This watermark gets removed from the finished version (and from Insider builds rolled out close to the release date), but you can easily add it back, so you can check at a glance which version of Windows you're running.

To do this, open the Registry Editor and navigate to

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop

Locate **PaintDesktopVersion** under the **Desktop** key, double-click it and change its value from **0** to **1**. Restart Windows and you'll see the version and build number on the desktop.

Disable automatic driver updates in Windows 10

Windows 10 downloads and installs the latest versions of drivers automatically to keep your system up to date. Sometimes, though, it might install problematic drivers, and there's no longer a way to stop the operating system doing this through Settings.

Luckily, you can take back control through the Registry. Open **regedit** and navigate to

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\ Windows

Right-click the Windows key and select **New, Key**. Call this **WindowsUpdate**. Right-click the new key, select New, DWORD (32-bit) Value and name this key **ExcludeWUDriversInQualityUpdate**.

Double-click it and change its value from 0 to 1, then click OK. To start receiving driver updates again, right-click **ExcludeWUDriversInQualityUpdate** and select Delete.

Hide the 'Hi' greeting in Windows 10

When you install Windows 10 or upgrade to a new version, one of the first things you'll see is a welcome screen that starts with a 'Hi' greeting.

You can disable this rather cheesy message using a Registry tweak. Doing so won't actually speed up the configuration process, but will make it seem quicker.

Open **regedit**, and navigate to

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System.

Right-click in the right-hand pane and select **New, DWORD** (32-bit Value).

Name this key **EnableFirstLogonAnimation**, double-click it and ensure its value is set to 0.

The animation will now be hidden and instead, you'll see a spinning circle and a 'Preparing Windows' message.

Disable App Launch Tracking

Windows 10 tracks the apps you launch and uses this information to customize your experience, tailor the Start menu to suit you and make other tweaks you never asked for.

If you don't find this helpful, or if you're concerned about your privacy, you can disable this tracking through Privacy Settings or via a Registry tweak.

For the latter option, open regedit and navigate to

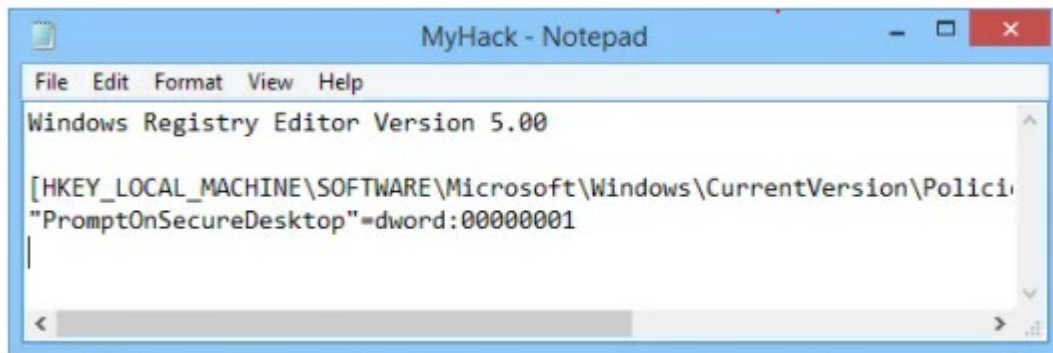
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced

Right-click in the right-hand pane and go to New, DWORD (32-bit) Value. Call this **Start_TrackProgs**. Set its value to **0** to disable app-launch tracking, and 1 to re-enable it. Restart your PC to action the change

CREATE YOUR OWN REGISTRY HACKS

Once you've applied a Registry tweak to one PC, you may want to repeat it on another computer. Instead of going through the whole process again, you can output your tweak as a Registry hack that can be run elsewhere (this will merge the changes with the target device's Registry).

All you need to do is select the key you made the change to, right-click



it, choose Export and give it a name. If your tweak involves more than one key, save each one, then right-click your first saved REG file and select Edit. Open the second key and paste the main [Hkey] part below the first.

You will need to have 'Windows Registry Editor Version 5.00' entered at the top of the page. This should only appear once in the REG file.

How to Stop programs leaving junk in your Registry

When you install a program on your PC, it makes changes to the Windows Registry. These changes should all be reversed when you uninstall the software, but that's not always the case.

You can correct this yourself by using the Registry Editor (or a number of even better tools, but it's tricky work and you need to know what you're doing).

We recommend that you always create a restore point and back up your Registry before you start tinkering with its settings.

Regshot lets you take a snapshot of your Windows Registry before and after you install software, so you can spot any changes.

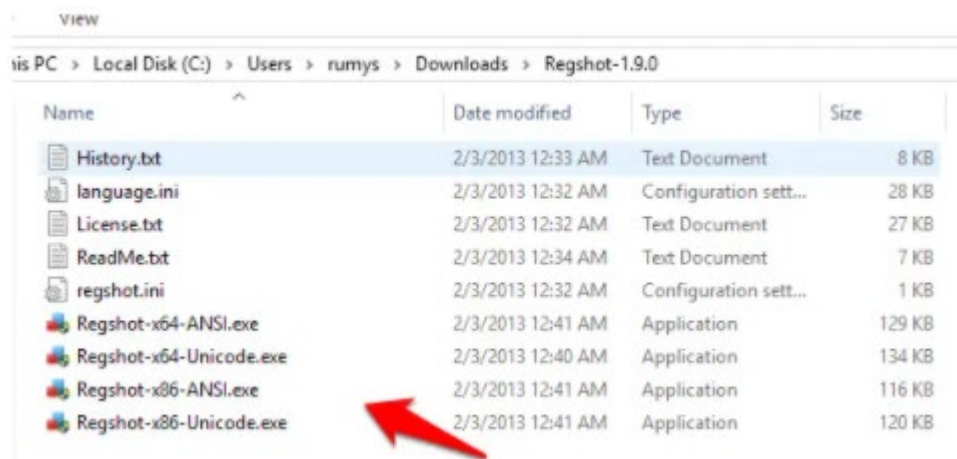
You can then take more snapshots when uninstalling the software, and check that those changes have been rectified. Regshot's files are in the compressed 7Z format.

If you don't already have a tool that will open them, download and use 7-Zip (www.7-zip.org).

Step1:- The software is portable so you don't need to install it, just unpack the files. There are four executable files.

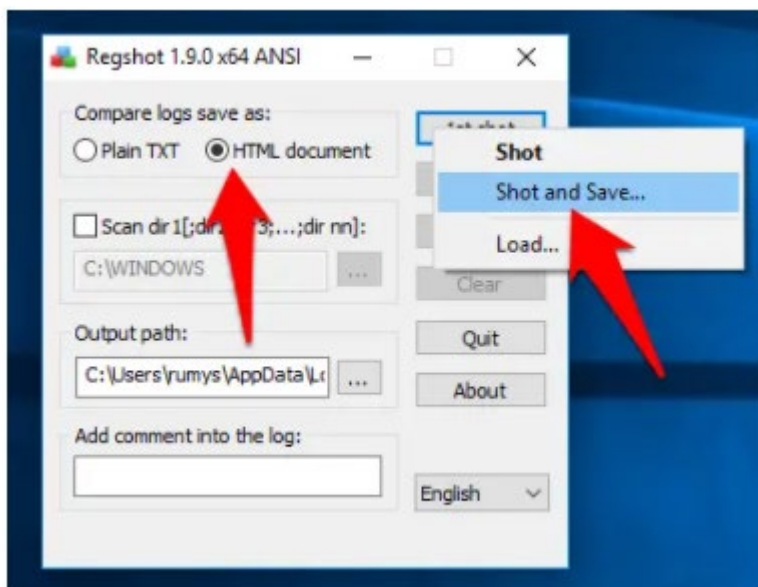
If you're using a 64-bit version of Windows, double-click Regshotx64-ANSI.32-bit users should use Regshot-x86-ANSI.

The Unicode versions are for PCs using international characters.



Step2:- Choose the **HTML option**. The text version is quicker to load but the HTML version doesn't take much longer and it looks nicer, too.

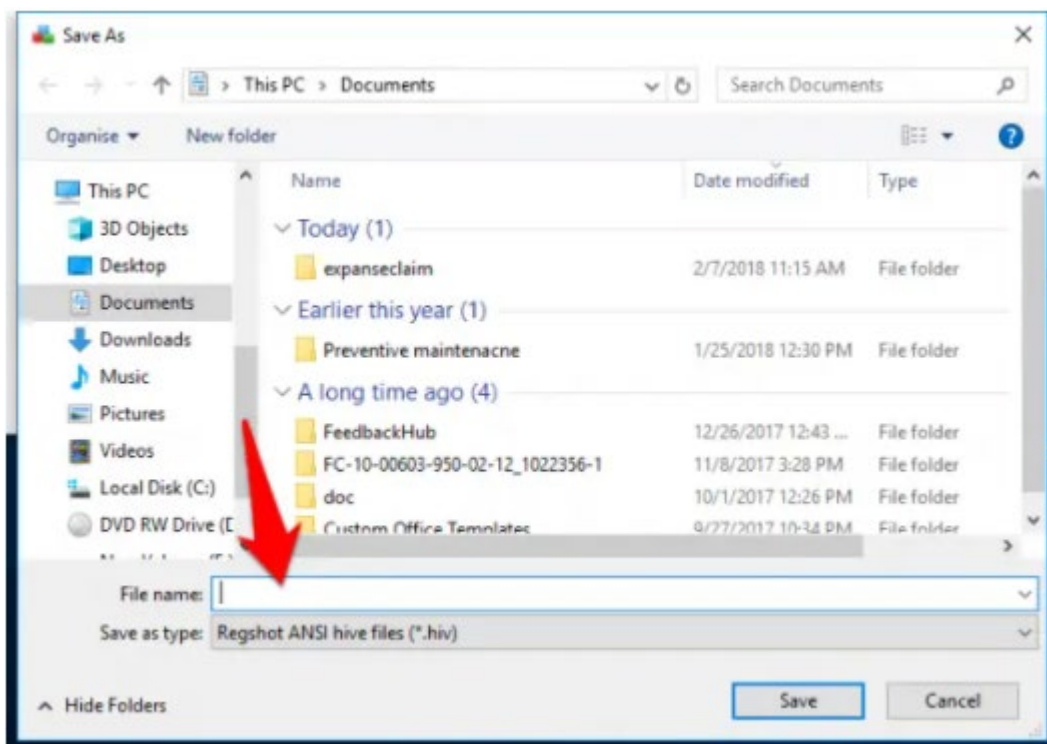
Click the '**1st shot**' button and choose '**Shot and Save**'. After a couple of minutes, a Save As box opens so you can choose where to save it.



Step3:- It's worth thinking about how you save your snapshots so it's easy to find and identify them later.

Create a folder specifically for this kind of file somewhere sensible, such as in your Documents folder.

Also, name the files descriptively, so you can see what they are at a glance.



Step4:- Having taken your first snapshot, you can now install the program you want to monitor.

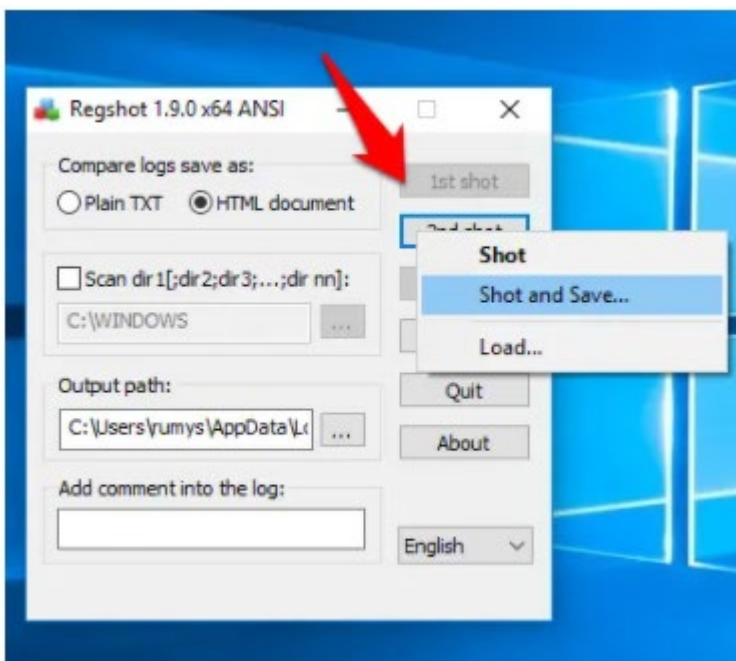
Try to do this as soon as possible after the first snapshot, to minimize the amount of interference from anything else that's going on in the background on your computer.



Step5:- When the software has finished installing, click '**2nd shot**'. From the options, choose 'Shot and Save'.

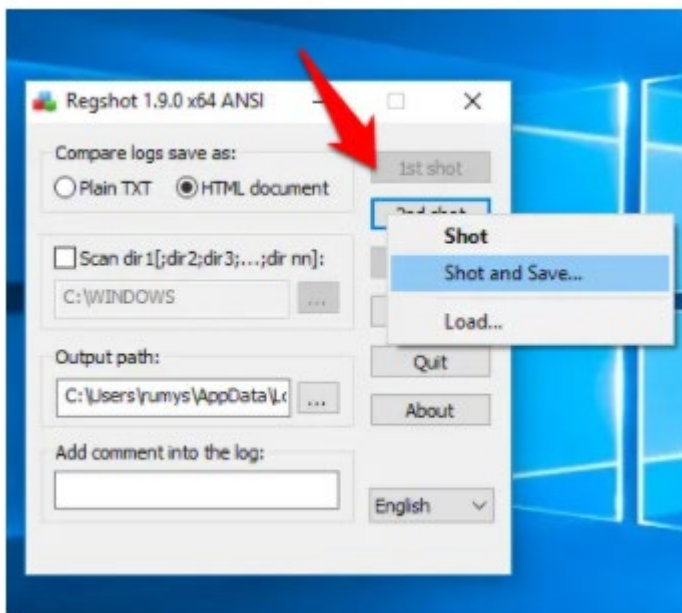
If you closed Regshot between snapshots, you may need to reload the first snapshot before comparing them.

Click the appropriate snapshot button, choose Load 2 and select the file to restore it.



Step6:- Click the **Compare** button. If you selected the HTML option, your browser will now open displaying the results.

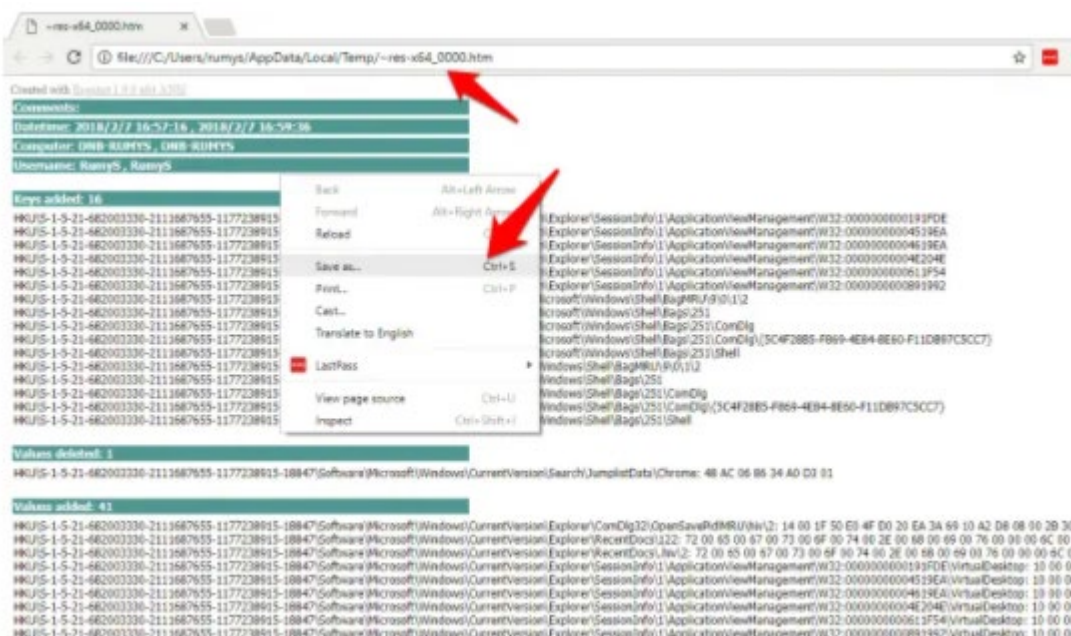
There will be a lot of Registry changes listed, many of which specifically mention the software you've installed.



Step7:- The log files will be saved to the folder specified under '**Output path**' and automatically named.

To better organize them, right-click a blank area of the page, select '**Save as**' and save the file to the folder where you're keeping your other Regshot files.

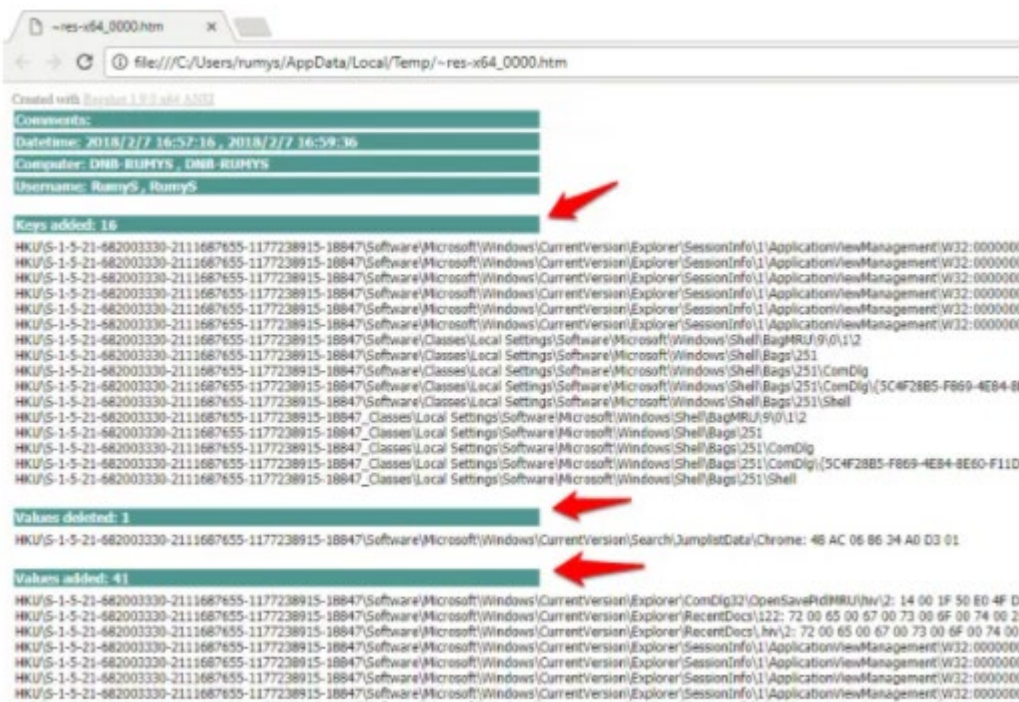
Give them a name that makes sense to you.



Step8:- Go through the process again when you uninstall the software, taking one snapshot before you start and another when it's finished.

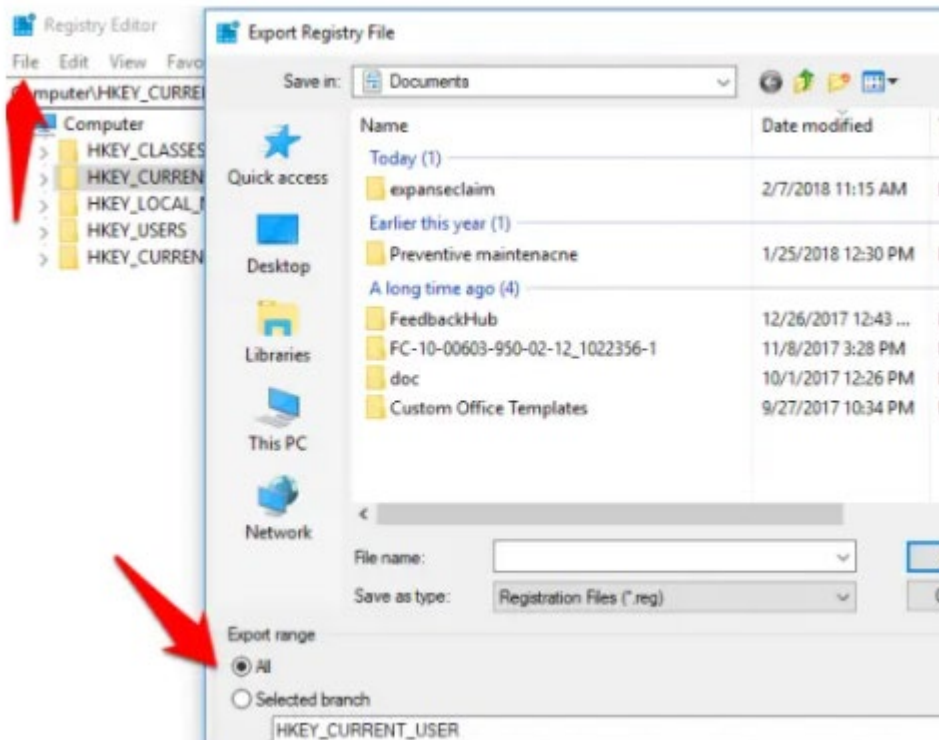
Compare the two files and create an HTML document.

Hopefully, it will list many of the changes that also appeared in your first HTML document.



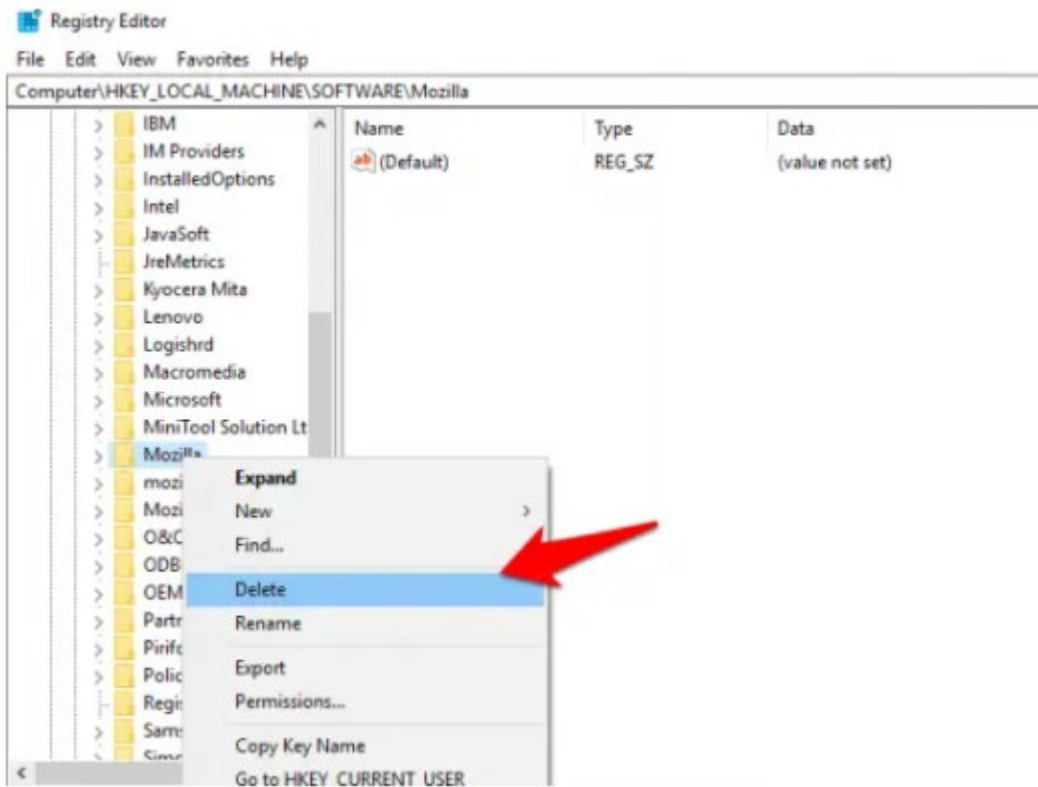
Step9:- If you find references to the program you installed in the first HTML document that aren't in the second, press Windows+R, type regedit and press Enter.

Back up the Registry by opening the **File** menu and choosing **Export**. Under 'Export range', ensure that the All option is selected.



Step10:- Use the folder tree in the left-hand panel to navigate your way to any leftover Registry entries. Right-click the item and choose Delete.

If the changes you make cause problems on your PC, you can restore your Registry backup using Import from the File menu.



We are recommending [Windows Registry Troubleshooting](#) and [Windows 10 Troubleshooting \(Windows Troubleshooting Series\)](#) Guide to read for more information on Windows 10 and registry.